

General Support Guide

1. Notification Preferences

Notifications can be managed under Settings > Notifications. Users may toggle email, SMS, and in-app notifications independently for each category listed below.

Notification Categories

- Security alerts (login from new device, password changes): Cannot be fully disabled, only switched between email and SMS delivery.
- Billing notifications (upcoming charges, failed payments): Enabled by default, recommended to keep active.
- Product updates and newsletters: Disabled by default, opt-in only.
- Usage alerts (approaching plan limits): Triggered automatically at 80 percent and 100 percent of quota usage.

Notification preference changes take effect immediately and apply across all devices linked to the account. There is no delay or sync period.

2. Account Deletion and Data Retention

Requesting Account Deletion

Account deletion can be requested from Settings > Account > Delete Account, or by emailing support directly. A confirmation email is sent before deletion is finalized, requiring the user to click a confirmation link within 48 hours.

Data Retention Timeline

Once confirmed, the account enters a 30-day grace period during which it can still be recovered by logging in again. After 30 days, all personal data, usage history, and uploaded content is permanently deleted from production systems. Backup systems may retain encrypted copies for up to an additional 90 days for disaster recovery purposes only, after which they are also purged.

Data Export Before Deletion

Users are strongly encouraged to export their data before initiating deletion. A full data export can be requested from Settings > Privacy > Export My Data, which generates a downloadable archive within 24 hours. This export option remains available throughout the 30-day grace period but not after permanent deletion occurs.

3. Service Status and Incident Communication

Real-time system status is available at status.example.com, which displays current uptime for all major services including the API, web dashboard, and mobile app backend.

Incident Severity Levels

- Minor: Localized slowdowns affecting a small subset of users. Status page updated within 30 minutes of detection.

- Major: Significant feature degradation affecting many users. Status page updated within 10 minutes, with hourly updates until resolved.
- Critical: Full service outage. Status page updated within 5 minutes, with updates every 30 minutes, and a follow-up postmortem published within 5 business days of resolution.

Users can subscribe to status page updates via email or SMS to receive alerts automatically during incidents without needing to check the page manually.

4. General Contact Channels

Live chat support is available Monday through Friday, 9am to 9pm EST, accessible from the help icon in the bottom right of the dashboard. Email support (support@example.com) is monitored 24/7 with a target first response time of 4 business hours. Phone support is reserved for Professional and Enterprise plan customers and is available during business hours listed in the relevant plan documentation.

For escalated or unresolved issues, customers may request a callback by submitting a ticket marked Urgent, which routes directly to a senior support specialist within 1 business hour.